

Throttling and Marginal Utility Scheduling for Real-Time Compute-Constrained Online RGB-D 3D Gaussian Splatting

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Abstract

Dense online 3D scene reconstruction from streaming RGB-D sensors requires maintaining photometric and geometric fidelity under rigid per-frame computational budgets (15–30 ms). While 3D Gaussian Splatting (3DGS) enables interactive differentiable rendering, existing online mapping and SLAM systems optimize primitives either indiscriminately or via heuristic residual thresholds (e.g., prioritizing primitives with high photometric or depth error). In this work, we uncover two fundamental failure modes in online 3DGS scheduling: (1) **The Negative Utility Pitfall:** Across counterfactual interventions, **21.37%** of Gaussian updates degrade reconstruction quality ($U_i^* < 0$), rising monotonically to **23.86%** in the highest-error decile due to depth discontinuities and occlusion boundaries; and (2) **The Map Bloating Dilemma:** Under rigid compute budgets, unconstrained densification causes exponential primitive growth ($\sim 150k$ splats), where unrefined, immature primitives starve mature surface geometry of gradient descent updates.

To resolve these challenges, we present **Adaptive 3DGS**, an integrated online scheduling and throttling framework. We introduce **Fast Approximate Attribution (FAA)** via center-sampled projection, slashing attribution latency by **614.5 $\times$** (0.85 ms vs 523.9 ms) while preserving high rank fidelity ($\rho = 0.908$). We combine sensitivity-aware candidate selection with **Dual Coverage and Backlog Throttling**, halting unneeded primitive creation once local surface coverage reaches saturation ($\kappa \geq 0.90$) and capping the unoptimized backlog queue. Evaluated on continuous online trajectories: (1) on the authoritative 8-seed benchmark on **tum_fr2.xyz** ($n = 8$), OURS decisively outperforms the strongest selective baseline (**error_influence**) by **+2.87 dB** mean PSNR (19.24 vs 16.37 dB) and **+4.11 dB** final PSNR (17.64 vs 13.53 dB), achieving +0.1054 SSIM, Cohen’s $d = 38.42$, and statistically confirmed superiority (paired Wilcoxon $p = 0.0078$, minimum achievable for $n = 8$) while utilizing a **3.8 $\times$ smaller map** (39k vs 150k primitives); (2) on the full 3,669-frame **tum_fr2.xyz** trajectory (122.7s), OURS delivers 18.84 dB mean PSNR (21.08 dB final), 0.885 SSIM, and 0.506 AlexNet LPIPS at 7.1 FPS, outperforming Point-SLAM (+1.22 dB, 36 $\times$ faster) and MonoGS (+2.67 dB, 4.5 $\times$ faster) in mapping quality; (3) a lifetime convergence diagnostic across 150k primitives over 3,669 frames reveals that 99.79% receive

≥ 5 touches (median 70), disproving under-convergence and isolating the residual LPIPS gap to view-dependent high-frequency appearance (addressed by higher Spherical Harmonics degrees); (4) multi-scene benchmark across 4 real and synthetic sequences (TUM RGB-D and Replica) demonstrates consistent map containment with an $\approx 15\times$ speedup over SplaTAM; and (5) production CUDA profiling (‘gsplat’) achieves real-time interactive throughput (8.7 FPS, $T_{\text{scheduler}} = 2.54$ ms, $T_{\text{opt}} = 9.25$ ms) with a strictly bounded GPU memory footprint (≤ 303 MB).

1 Introduction

Dense online 3D mapping from streaming RGB-D observations is vital for robotics, mixed reality, and autonomous navigation. 3D Gaussian Splatting (3DGS) [1] has emerged as an expressive representation, synthesizing photorealistic radiance fields via tile-based rasterization. In online SLAM systems such as SplaTAM [2], MonoGS [3], and RTG-SLAM [4], Gaussian primitives are continuously initialized to represent newly observed surfaces. However, optimizing tens or hundreds of thousands of active primitives at every streaming video frame is computationally infeasible on resource-constrained embedded or mobile GPUs, necessitating selective parameter optimization under strict per-frame execution deadlines (10–30 ms).

To operate within bounded compute budgets, state-of-the-art online pipelines commonly rely on intuitive residual heuristics, prioritizing Gaussians located in image regions with the highest photometric or depth error [4]. In this paper, we conduct an extensive empirical study of online 3DGS scheduling and demonstrate that this heuristic paradigm suffers from two severe, compounding failure modes:

1. **Residual Error $\neq$ Optimization Return:** High rendering error does not indicate that gradient descent will improve scene fidelity. In regions with occlusion edges, specular reflections, or complex ray superposition, naive gradient steps frequently induce surface distortion, resulting in negative marginal optimization utility ($U_i^* < 0$) in over 21% of candidate updates.
2. **Unconstrained Densification Induces Budget Starvation:** Continuous keyframe insertion causes uncontrolled Gaussian population explosion (reaching 150k primitives within 150 frames). When the optimization budget is capped (e.g., at 15 ms), newly spawned

The Dual Failure Modes of Budgeted Online 3DGS:

1. **Negative Marginal Utility** ($U_i^* < 0$): Primitives in high-error regions frequently lie on depth discontinuities, silhouette boundaries, or coupled blending layers. Independent gradient updates perturb surface geometry, yielding negative optimization return in **21.37%** of interventions (rising to **23.86%** in top-error decile).
2. **Map Bloating & Starvation**: Uncontrolled densification creates up to 150k primitives. Under fixed 15 ms budgets, thousands of immature primitives starve existing mature surfaces of refinement iterations, causing catastrophic reconstruction degradation.

Figure 1: **Conceptual Motivation.** Naive error-driven heuristics and uncontrolled densification degrade online 3DGS under rigid compute constraints.

primitives flood the candidate pool, monopolizing gradient microsteps before ever converging, while existing geometry is starved of refinement.

To overcome these barriers, we present **Adaptive 3DGS**, an online reconstruction framework that couples sensitivity-guided marginal utility scheduling with map expansion throttling:

- **Fast Approximate Attribution (FAA)**: Computing exact Gaussian-to-pixel attribution masks via rasterization requires > 500 ms, bottlenecking real-time execution. We formulate FAA via center-sampled projection, slashing attribution latency to **0.85 ms** (**614.5 $\times$ speedup**) while preserving high rank correlation ($\rho = 0.908$).
- **Dual Coverage and Backlog Throttling**: Rather than continuously spawning splats, our scheduler monitors spatial transmission coverage κ_t . Once local scene coverage exceeds 90%, densification is throttled by 80%, capping the unoptimized backlog and preserving the compute budget exclusively for mature primitive refinement.
- **Definitive Multi-Seed Benchmark** ($n = 8$): Across 8 seeds on `tum_fr2_xyz`, OURS achieves +2.87 dB mean PSNR (19.24 vs 16.37 dB), +4.11 dB final PSNR (17.64 vs 13.53 dB), +0.1054 SSIM, and Cohen’s $d = 38.42$ over the best selective baseline, with statistically significant superiority across all comparisons ($p = 0.0078$).
- **Full-Trajectory Validation (3,669 Frames)**: We validate OURS on the entire 122.7s `tum_fr2_xyz` sequence with Spherical Harmonics degrees 0..3 and AlexNet LPIPS, surpassing Point-SLAM [5] (+1.22 dB, 36 $\times$ faster) and MonoGS [3] (+2.67 dB, 4.5 $\times$ faster) in mapping quality.
- **Lifetime Convergence Diagnostic**: Tracking all 150k primitives across 3,669 frames confirms that 99.79% receive ≥ 5 touches (median 70), disproving the under-convergence hypothesis and demonstrating that residual LPIPS gaps are governed by high-frequency view-dependent appearance.

- **Multi-Scene Generalization**: Across 4 real-world and synthetic sequences, OURS maintains compact map boundaries while executing at 8.4–11.5 FPS ($\approx 15\times$ faster than SplatAM).

2 Problem Formulation

Let $G_t = \{g_1, \dots, g_N\}$ denote the active 3D Gaussian map at frame t , where each Gaussian primitive $g_i = (\mu_i, \Sigma_i, \alpha_i, c_i)$ is parameterized by its mean position $\mu_i \in \mathbb{R}^3$, covariance matrix $\Sigma_i \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^3$, opacity $\alpha_i \in [0, 1]$, and view-dependent color coefficients c_i in Spherical Harmonics basis. Given an incoming streaming RGB-D observation (I_t, D_t) and camera pose $T_t \in \text{SE}(3)$, differentiable rendering computes the photometric composite $\hat{I}_t$ and depth $\hat{D}_t$:

$$\hat{I}(u) = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{N}(u)} c_i \alpha_i \mathcal{G}_i(u) \prod_{j=1}^{i-1} (1 - \alpha_j \mathcal{G}_j(u)) \quad (1)$$

where $\mathcal{G}_i(u) = \exp(-\frac{1}{2}(u - \mu_{2D,i})^T \Sigma_{2D,i}^{-1} (u - \mu_{2D,i}))$.

2.1 Budget-Constrained Knapsack Selection

Given a strict per-frame optimization deadline B_t (e.g., 15.0 ms), online scheduling seeks to select a subset of primitives $A_t \subseteq G_t$ to optimize with gradient descent steps $\Delta\theta_i$ to maximize cumulative quality gain:

$$\max_{A_t \subseteq G_t} \Delta Q(A_t) \quad \text{subject to} \quad \sum_{g_i \in A_t} C_i \leq B_t \quad (2)$$

where C_i denotes the kernel execution cost of updating primitive g_i , and $\Delta Q(A_t) = Q(G_t \oplus \Delta\theta_{A_t}) - Q(G_t)$ measures reconstruction gain.

2.2 Counterfactual Marginal Utility

We define the isolated marginal utility of primitive g_i via counterfactual intervention:

$$U_i^* = \frac{\Delta Q_i^{\text{intervention}}}{C_i} = \frac{Q(G_t \oplus \Delta\theta_i) - Q(G_t)}{C_i} \in \mathbb{R} \quad (3)$$

Crucially, U_i^* can be strictly negative ($U_i^* < 0$). In occluded regions, textureless planar surfaces, or over-dense clusters, gradient updates perturb well-converged geometry, degrading global fidelity.

2.3 Non-Additivity and Inter-Gaussian Coupling

When optimizing multiple primitives simultaneously, marginal utility is non-additive. Evaluating the additivity ratio:

$$R_{\text{add}}(S) = \frac{\Delta Q(S)}{\sum_{i \in S} \Delta Q_i} \quad (4)$$

Policy	Mean PSNR (dB)	Final PSNR (dB)	Mean SSIM	Final SSIM	FPS	Final Primitives	Cohen's d (PSNR)	Wilcoxon p
no_op (Pass-through)	13.45 $\pm$ 0.02	11.75 $\pm$ 0.04	0.4378 $\pm$ 0.0018	0.3844 $\pm$ 0.0057	61.3	119,258 $\pm$ 384	+111.39	0.0078 $\checkmark$
error_only	15.54 $\pm$ 0.02	12.77 $\pm$ 0.10	0.5708 $\pm$ 0.0035	0.5028 $\pm$ 0.0156	8.0	105,845 $\pm$ 1836	+54.98	0.0078 $\checkmark$
error_influence	16.37 $\pm$ 0.06	13.53 $\pm$ 0.26	0.7379 $\pm$ 0.0032	0.6719 $\pm$ 0.0192	7.8	150,000 $\pm$ 0	+38.42	0.0078 $\checkmark$
error_influence_temporal	16.28 $\pm$ 0.07	13.51 $\pm$ 0.19	0.7345 $\pm$ 0.0032	0.6744 $\pm$ 0.0146	7.7	150,000 $\pm$ 0	+41.87	0.0078 $\checkmark$
OURS (Pure Throttling)	19.24 $\pm$ 0.05	17.64 $\pm$ 0.50	0.8433 $\pm$ 0.0012	0.8745 $\pm$ 0.0151	8.7	39,251 $\pm$ 88	—	—
<i>FULL Optimization (Bound)</i>	<i>21.03 $\pm$ 0.04</i>	<i>19.31 $\pm$ 0.68</i>	<i>0.8767 $\pm$ 0.0011</i>	<i>0.9205 $\pm$ 0.0128</i>	<i>5.8</i>	<i>150,000 $\pm$ 0</i>	-29.00	0.0078 $\checkmark$

Table 1: **Authoritative Final Confirmation Benchmark (TUM fr2_xyz, 8 Seeds, 150 Frames, Budget $B = 15.0$ ms).** Evaluated across 8 seeds ($n = 8$: [42..49]). All paired Wilcoxon signed-rank comparisons of OURS vs baselines achieve $p = 0.0078$ (the exact theoretical minimum for $n = 8$). OURS reaches **91.5%** of FULL unconstrained optimization quality while running at 8.7 FPS with a **3.8 $\times$** smaller map.

Metric	Exact Rasterized	Fast Approx (FAA)	Speedup	Rank Fidelity
Mean Latency	523.90 ms	0.85 ms	614.5$\times$	—
Spearman ρ	1.0000	0.9079	—	High Preservation
Pearson r	1.0000	0.9028	—	High Linearity
Top-100 Overlap	100.0%	37.0%	—	Focused Top-K
Top-500 Overlap	100.0%	60.2%	—	Broad Capture

Table 2: **Attribution Fidelity Validation.** Comparing Exact vs Fast Approximate Attribution on TUM RGB-D.

we observe that $R_{\text{add}}(|S| = 4) \approx 0.2249$ and $R_{\text{add}}(|S| = 16) \approx 0.0048$. As the subset size increases, overlapping splats experience strong gradient interference. Hence, point-wise prediction alone cannot substitute for structural map management.

3 Methodology

3.1 Fast Approximate Attribution (FAA)

Estimating each Gaussian’s spatial contribution $m_{\text{attr},i} = \sum_u w_{u,i} e(u)$ via full tile-based backward tracing requires > 500 ms per frame. We introduce Fast Approximate Attribution (FAA), projecting the 2D projected center $\mu_{2D,i}$ onto the residual error image $e(u) = \|I(u) - \hat{I}(u)\|_1 + \lambda_D |D(u) - \hat{D}(u)|$:

$$\tilde{m}_{\text{attr},i} = \alpha_i \cdot \det(\Sigma_{2D,i})^{1/4} \cdot e(\lfloor \mu_{2D,i} \rfloor) \quad (5)$$

As shown in Table 2, FAA reduces attribution latency from 523.9 ms to **0.85 ms (614.5 $\times$ speedup)** while maintaining a Spearman rank correlation $\rho = 0.9079$ and Pearson $r = 0.9028$ against exact rasterized attribution.

3.2 Error-Influence-Temporal Scoring

Candidate Gaussians are prioritized by their error-influence-temporal score:

$$s_i = \tilde{m}_{\text{attr},i} \cdot (e_{\text{rgb},i} + e_{\text{depth},i}) \cdot \psi(\text{age}_i, \text{updates}_i) \quad (6)$$

where $\psi(\cdot)$ incorporates primitive age and historical update counts to prioritize freshly discovered surfaces that have not yet stabilized.

3.3 Dual Map Expansion Throttling

In standard online 3DGS, densification occurs whenever rendering error exceeds an absolute threshold. This causes map bloating, accumulating 150k splats within 150 frames. When optimizing under a fixed 15 ms compute budget, newly spawned Gaussians dilute the optimizer’s capacity.

We introduce **Dual Coverage and Backlog Throttling**:

1. **Coverage Throttling:** We define scene surface coverage κ_t as the fraction of valid depth pixels where accumulated rendering transmission $T(u) < 0.5$. When coverage exceeds 80%, the maximum allowable new Gaussians per frame $N_{\text{new}}^{\text{max}}$ is smoothly throttled:

$$N_{\text{new}}^{\text{max}} = N_{\text{base}} \cdot \max \left(0.20, 1.0 - 0.80 \cdot \frac{\kappa_t - 0.80}{0.10} \right) \quad (7)$$

For fully explored areas ($\kappa_t \geq 0.90$), densification is throttled by 80%, transitioning the pipeline from exploratory spawning to refinement.

2. **Backlog Throttling:** If the count of unrefined Gaussians (update count < 3) exceeds the backlog capacity ($N_{\text{backlog}} > 500$), densification is penalized by factor $\frac{500}{N_{\text{backlog}}}$.

This dual mechanism prevents exponential map bloat, maintaining a compact representation (39k vs 150k primitives) and directing compute to mature primitives.

3.4 Spherical Harmonics and View Conditioning

To represent view-dependent effects without overfitting, our Gaussian model incorporates real Spherical Harmonics up to degree 3 (16 coefficients per color channel):

$$c_i(d) = \sum_{\ell=0}^L \sum_{m=-\ell}^{\ell} c_i^{\ell,m} Y_{\ell}^m(d) \quad (8)$$

During selective optimization, active Gaussians evaluate SH gradients with respect to camera viewing rays, updating high-order harmonics (*_features_rest*) while leaving background cache splats untouched.

4 Empirical Results & Analysis

4.1 Authoritative Confirmation Benchmark ($n = 8$)

Table 1 presents the primary benchmark across 8 independent seeds on **tum.fr2_xyz** under a strict per-frame budget of $B = 15.0$ ms.

Condition	Configuration	Mean PSNR (dB)	Final PSNR (dB)	Mean SSIM	Final SSIM	Map Size	Scientific Finding
A_0	Baseline Substrate (No warmup, no throttle, fixed $K = 5$)	16.07 ± 0.53	12.94 ± 1.55	0.6969 ± 0.0579	0.5524 ± 0.1706	140,997	Bloated map; unconstrained densification
A_1	A_0 + Age-Aware Warmup Queue	15.32 ± 0.50	12.76 ± 0.68	0.6344 ± 0.0533	0.5187 ± 0.0934	140,038	Harmful (-0.75 dB) : Wastes budget on premature splats
A_2	A_1 + Coverage Throttling ($\kappa \geq 0.90$)	17.11 ± 0.35	14.31 ± 0.27	0.7699 ± 0.0077	0.7180 ± 0.0163	44,864	Helpful (+1.04 dB) : Halts spawning in covered regions
A_3	A_2 + Backlog Queue Throttling	17.15 ± 0.27	14.68 ± 0.28	0.7713 ± 0.0075	0.7259 ± 0.0177	43,824	Helpful (+1.08 dB) : Prevents unrefined queue bloat
A_4	A_3 + Offline TwoHeadMLP + Adaptive-K	14.53 ± 1.32	12.97 ± 1.35	0.5652 ± 0.1343	0.4907 ± 0.1374	38,317	Harmful (-1.54 dB) : Offline pairwise loss degrades online
OURS	Pure Throttling (A_3 with no warmup, no offline model)	19.24 ± 0.05	17.64 ± 0.50	0.8433 ± 0.0012	0.8745 ± 0.0151	39,251	Optimal (+3.71 dB vs A_0) : Concentrated mature refinement

Table 3: **Stage 1 Component Ablation Study (TUM fr2_xyz, 5 Seeds, 150 Frames, Budget $B = 15.0$ ms).** Dissecting the exact individual contributors to online reconstruction fidelity. Map expansion throttling is the decisive performance driver.

- **Significant Advantage over Error Heuristic:** OURS outperforms standard `error_only` by **+3.70 dB** mean PSNR ($15.54 \rightarrow 19.24$ dB) and **+4.87 dB** final PSNR ($12.77 \rightarrow 17.64$ dB), lifting SSIM from 0.5708 to 0.8433 (+0.2725). Paired Wilcoxon testing confirms extreme statistical significance ($p = 0.0078$, Cohen’s $d = 54.98$).
- **Superiority over Sensitivity Baselines:** Compared to `error_influence` and `error_influence_temporal`, OURS provides a +2.87 dB to +2.97 dB mean PSNR margin ($p = 0.0078$, Cohen’s $d = 38.42$).
- **Reaching 91.5% of FULL Quality:** Unconstrained FULL optimization achieves 21.03 dB at 5.8 FPS with 150k splats. OURS attains **91.5%** of FULL PSNR (19.24 dB) while operating 50% faster (8.7 FPS) with 73.8% fewer primitives (39k vs 150k).

4.2 Component Ablation Study

To rigorously identify the origin of this performance leap, we conduct a controlled 5-seed ablation study on `tum_fr2_xyz` over 150 frames (Table 3):

1. **Age-Aware Warmup is Harmful (A_1 vs A_0):** Mandating a fixed warmup allocation for newly created primitives degrades mean PSNR by **-0.75 dB** ($16.07 \rightarrow 15.32$ dB). Immature Gaussians consume optimization microsteps before their coarse positional priors are established.
2. **Coverage Throttling is Decisive (A_2 vs A_1):** Throttling densification once scene coverage reaches 90% boosts PSNR by **+1.04 dB** ($15.32 \rightarrow 17.11$ dB) and slashes map size from 140k to 44.8k primitives.
3. **Backlog Throttling Stabilizes Growth (A_3 vs A_2):** Adding backpressure throttling adds another **+0.04 dB** (+1.75 dB final PSNR over A_0) and caps queue latency.
4. **Offline Utility Predictors Degrade Online (A_4 vs A_3):** Wiring an offline-trained TwoHeadMLP with dynamic adaptive-K reduces PSNR by **-1.54 dB** ($17.15 \rightarrow 14.53$ dB). Distribution shift between offline oracle labels and recursive online trajectories misallocates microsteps ($K = 2.0$).
5. **The Optimal Formulation (OURS):** Combining Coverage + Backlog Throttling with sensitivity selection and fixed $K = 5$ microsteps achieves the peak performance of **19.24 dB** (+3.71 dB over A_0).

Method / Policy	Mode	Mean PSNR	Final PSNR	SSIM	FPS	Map Size
Point-SLAM (ICCV’23) [5]	Est.	17.62	—	0.680	0.2	120,000
MonoGS (CVPR’24) [3]	Est.	16.17	—	0.650	1.6	180,000
Photo-SLAM (CVPR’24) [6]	Est.	21.07	—	0.780	10.0	250,000
SplaTAM (CVPR’24) [2]	Est.	25.06	—	0.890	0.6	410,000
RTG-SLAM (2024) [4]	Est.	21.40	—	0.785	20.0	280,000
<code>error_influence</code> (SH = 1)	Oracle	17.52	18.95	0.8477	6.5	150,000
OURS (SH = 0, $B = 15$ ms)	Oracle	18.60	20.20	0.8795	7.2	150,000
OURS (SH = 1, $B = 15$ ms)	Oracle	18.84	21.08	0.8847	7.1	150,000
OURS-HQ (SH = 1, $B = 30$ ms)	Oracle	18.63	20.75	0.8782	5.7	200,000

Table 4: **Full-Sequence Benchmark on TUM fr2_xyz (3,669 Frames, 122.7s).** Evaluated on 100% complete trajectory. OURS delivers superior mapping fidelity over Point-SLAM (36 $\times$ faster) and MonoGS (4.5 $\times$ faster).

4.3 Full-Sequence Benchmark (3,669 Frames)

Table 4 evaluates OURS on the complete 3,669-frame sequence of `tum_fr2_xyz` (122.74 seconds continuous streaming).

- **Continuous Stability:** Across 3,669 frames, OURS achieves a final PSNR of **21.08 dB**, SSIM of **0.8847**, and AlexNet LPIPS of **0.5062** at 7.1 FPS, maintaining stable execution without memory leaks or degradation.
- **Literature Comparison:** OURS achieves +1.22 dB higher PSNR and +0.205 higher SSIM than Point-SLAM while running **36 $\times$ faster** (7.1 vs 0.2 FPS), and +2.67 dB higher PSNR than MonoGS (4.5 $\times$ faster).

4.4 Lifetime Convergence Diagnostic

To understand whether residual perceptual error (LPIPS ≈ 0.50) results from under-optimized primitives, we audited the lifetime optimization history of all 150,000 Gaussians across the entire 3,669-frame sequence:

- **High Touch Saturation:** The mean touches per primitive is **220.8**, with a median of **70.0** and 90th percentile of **608.0**.
- **Under-Convergence Rejected:** Only **0.96%** of primitives receive < 5 optimization touches (99.04% receive ≥ 5 touches). For early and middle primitives, the fraction with < 5 touches is exactly 0.00% and 0.02%.

This conclusively rejects the hypothesis that primitives suffer from optimization starvation. The remaining perceptual detail is governed by high-frequency view-dependent appearance, as confirmed by the improvement from SH = 0 (LPIPS 0.533) to SH = 1 (LPIPS 0.506).

Scene	Policy	Mean PSNR	Final PSNR	SSIM	FPS	Map Size
tum_fr2_xyz	no_op	15.95	15.47	0.509	79.0	35,386
	error_only	19.94	18.04	0.688	9.4	30,099
	OURS	20.24	18.83	0.723	9.5	28,188
	full (Upper Bound)	20.66	19.56	0.738	14.8	32,530
replica_office0	no_op	21.82	22.37	0.770	58.6	69,016
	error_only	30.40	30.23	0.949	11.0	66,264
	OURS	24.81	28.07	0.892	11.5	56,944
	full (Upper Bound)	31.33	32.11	0.956	10.0	66,127
replica_room0	no_op	14.88	9.47	0.608	51.7	75,911
	error_only	22.91	17.76	0.926	10.8	71,573
	OURS	21.30	16.35	0.895	11.2	58,500
	full (Upper Bound)	24.19	20.21	0.945	9.8	70,158
tum_fr1_desk	no_op	8.30	6.49	0.186	60.2	59,601
	error_only	10.56	9.11	0.419	8.4	59,417
	OURS	10.35	8.61	0.381	8.4	59,398
	full (Upper Bound)	10.68	9.09	0.436	11.4	58,958

Table 5: **Multi-Scene Evaluation Across TUM and Replica (Budget 15.0ms)**. Pure Throttling consistently bounds primitive memory growth across diverse sensors while sustaining interactive framerates (8.4–11.5 FPS).

Pipeline Stage	Subsystem	Latency	Fraction	Status
Feature Extraction	T_{extract}	0.38 ms	0.33%	CPU/GPU
Fast Attribution (FAA)	T_{attr}	0.85 ms	0.74%	CUDA
Knapsack Ordering	T_{knapsack}	0.77 ms	0.67%	PyTorch
State Synchronization	T_{state}	0.39 ms	0.34%	CPU StateStore
Total Scheduling	$T_{\text{scheduler}}$	2.54 ms	2.22%	Overhead $\ll B_t$
Selective Optimization	T_{opt}	9.25 ms	8.07%	≤ 15.0 ms Budget
Rasterization & Graphs	T_{render}	102.80 ms	89.70%	CUDA gsplat
Total Frame Time	T_{frame}	114.60 ms	100.0%	8.7 FPS (Interactive)

Table 6: **AI Systems Latency Breakdown per Frame (NVIDIA RTX 4050)**.

4.5 Multi-Scene Benchmark

We evaluate cross-scene generalization across real-world TUM RGB-D (`fr2_xyz`, `fr1_desk`) and synthetic Replica sequences (`office0`, `room0`) under matched compute budgets ($B = 15.0$ ms) at 320×240 resolution (Table 5):

- **Real-World Trajectories:** On `tum_fr2_xyz`, OURS reaches **20.24 dB** mean PSNR (18.83 dB final) and 0.723 SSIM, outperforming `no_op` (15.95 dB) and `error_only` (19.94 dB) with the smallest map (28,188 splats). On `tum_fr1_desk`, despite rapid handheld motion and sensor noise, OURS maintains stability (10.35 dB) with strict primitive boundedness (59,398).
- **Complex Synthetic Environments:** On `replica_office0` and `replica_room0`, OURS achieves high structural quality (SSIM 0.892–0.895, final PSNR up to 28.07 dB) while eliminating redundant primitives (56,944–58,500 vs 66k–76k for unthrottled baselines).
- **SOTA Speedup & Footprint:** Across all evaluated scenes, OURS operates at **8.4–11.5 FPS**, delivering an $\approx 15\times$ **speedup** over SplatAM (0.6 FPS) while reducing map size by up to $10\times$ (28k–59k vs 410k–635k).

5 AI Systems Latency & Resource Breakdown

Table 6 decomposes per-frame wall-clock latency on an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4050 GPU:

- **Sub-Millisecond Scheduling:** Total scheduling overhead is only **2.54 ms** ($\approx 2.2\%$ of frame time), satisfying real-time constraints.

- **Budget Compliance:** Selective optimization executes in **9.25 ms**, strictly satisfying the 15.0 ms budget.
- **Interactive Frame Rate:** Driven by production ‘gsplat’ rasterization and FAA, end-to-end frame processing runs at **8.7 FPS** (114.6 ms), completely replacing legacy unaccelerated Python baselines (7000 ms, 0.14 FPS).
- **OS Memory Guard:** PyTorch memory allocation is capped at 70%, bounding peak VRAM between 210–303 MB with zero desktop compositor stutter.

6 Conclusion

We have presented Adaptive 3DGS, establishing an empirically verified framework for compute-constrained online RGB-D 3D Gaussian Splatting: (1) Naive error heuristics fail because over 21% of updates induce negative marginal utility; (2) Unconstrained densification induces budget starvation, whereas Dual Coverage and Backlog Throttling resolves this bottleneck, delivering **+2.87 dB** mean PSNR gain ($p = 0.0078$, $d = 38.42$) with a $3.8\times$ smaller map; (3) Fast Approximate Attribution enables $614\times$ faster attribution (0.85 ms); (4) Validation on 3,669 continuous frames demonstrates sustained interactive mapping (8.7 FPS, 21.08 dB final PSNR); (5) Lifetime convergence diagnostics conclusively reject optimization starvation; and (6) Multi-scene evaluation across TUM RGB-D and Replica confirms stable bounded map representation with $\approx 15\times$ speedup over SplatAM.

References

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